



WEBINAR SERIES #1: Pathway Towards Resilience: A Reflection on Nepal's Reconstruction Efforts and the Future

HIGHLIGHTS

- [Webinar sessions held to mark the fifth memorial day of Gorkha earthquake 2015:](#)
- [COVID-19 Pandemic: Live Updates & Nepal Humanitarian Response Update](#)
- [COVID - 19 Rapid Municipal Level Needs and Gap Assessment](#)
- [Stakeholders Response on Impacts of COVID-19 Crisis on Reconstruction at District/Municipal Level](#)
- [Quarantine Site Assessment](#)

FEATURED STORY: Bhagwati Tiwari a Social Mobilizer



Bhagwati Tiwari

*Social Mobilizer
Siddhalekh Rural Municipality,
Dhading*

Bhagwati Tiwari recalls her days when she used to lay down on her bed in the balcony of her two storey SMM house, talking to the villagers passing by and at far distance gazing and enjoying the beautiful view of villages and a light at Manakamana temple in Gorkha district. Those moments seem limited to only dreams now.

In the initial days, I was struggling with my work, and had no idea where to link the reconstruction support in the communities. After participating in the four-day training on “Social Mobilizers on earthquake resilient reconstruction” conducted by NRA and Building, I gained technical knowledge and skills in reconstruction, including communication skills. As a result, it has been easier to work with the communities in supporting the NRA in its aim to build back better houses and resilient communities.

Bhagwati says, people are happy now with the mobilization of Social Mobilizers and Mobile Masons in the field, as they can get support and discuss their concerns whenever they want. She further adds, the job is rewarding - to see change in communities, people who were once against retrofitting are now opting to retrofit their houses.

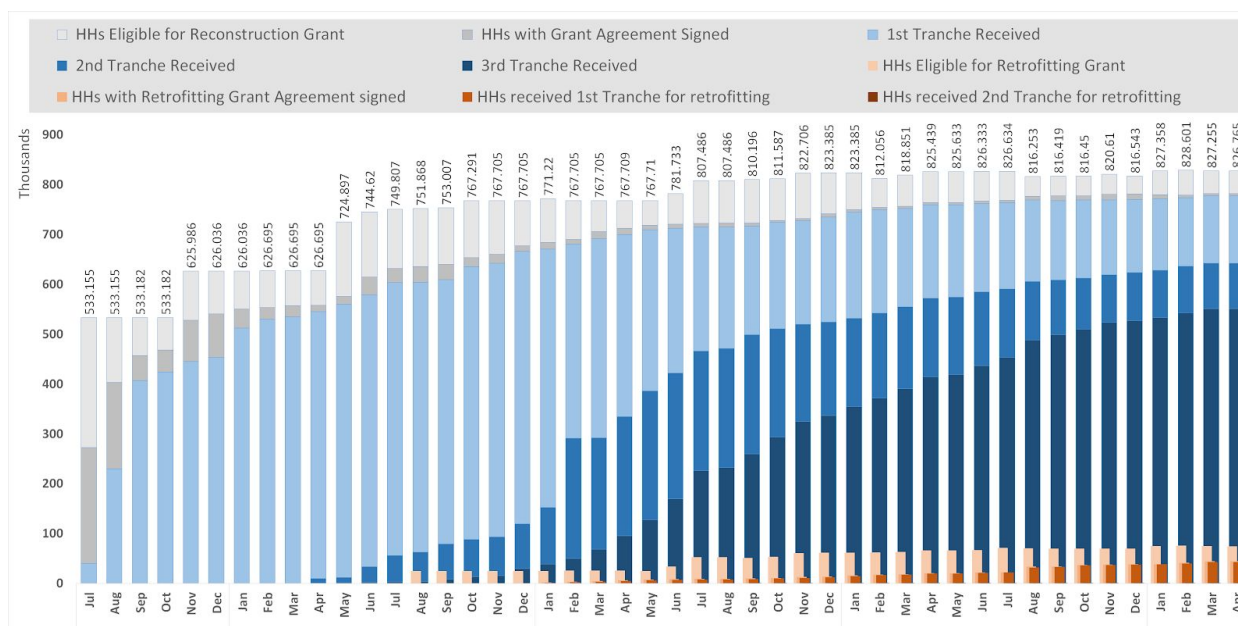
COVID - 19 Rapid Municipal Level Needs and Gap Assessment: HRRP conducted a rapid assessment of 71 municipalities across 28 districts from April 1 - 14 to find the general information on COVID-19 response activities, municipal level preparedness and planning surficial needs and gap analysis and sense of coping mechanisms at local level. The highlights from the survey are: (1) Community awareness programs have been effectively implemented, (2) Most Health workers are aware of the COVID-19 situation, (3) Only few municipalities have sufficient number of quarantine and isolation facilities, (4) Less access to market in all municipalities.



NATIONAL UPDATES

NRA, CLPIU GMaLI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 23 April 2020:

Reconstruction Grant	24 February	30 March	23 April
Total No. Eligible HHs	828601	827255	826765
HHs Enrolled	778253	781176	781176
HHs Received 1st Tranche	773058	776953	776957
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	643431	648889	648889
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	635750	641994	642026
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	3154	2812	2812
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	557818	565075	565076
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	542597	550532	550590
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	1962	2214	2214
Houses Completed	484542	494044	494044
HHs with Completion Certificate	80718	83019	83019
Retrofit Grant	24 February	30 March	23 April
Total No. Eligible HHs	75435	74745	74168
HHs Enrolled	41166	44115	44115
HHs Received 1st Tranche	39520	42854	42854
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	43	81	81



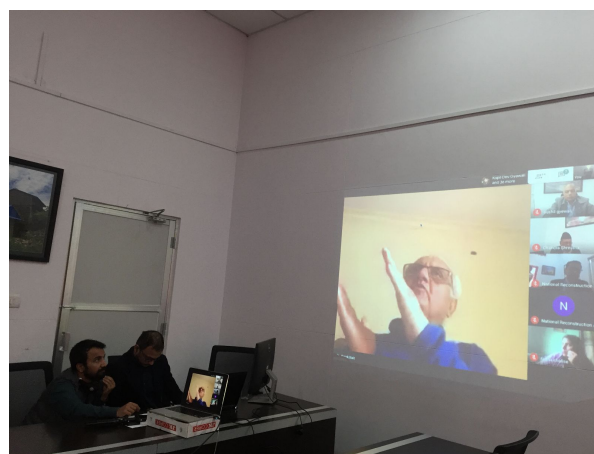
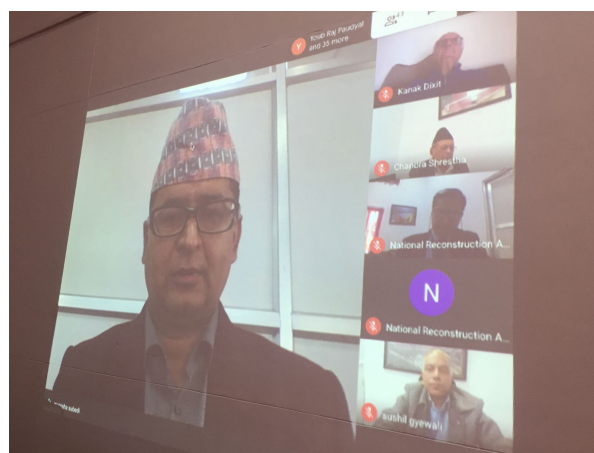
Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMaLI CLPIU data as of 23 April 2020.

NRA received a new Secretary: Mr. Ramkrishna Sapkota has been officially appointed as the NRA Secretary by the decision of the Cabinet meeting held on 14 April 2020. The newly appointed Secretary joined the NRA from 15 April.

Webinar session held to mark the fifth memorial day of Gorkha earthquake 2015:

On 23 April 2020, NRA and HRRP jointly organized a Webinar Session with the partner organizations, to mark the fifth anniversary of the Gorkha Earthquake 2015 on the theme, ***"The pathway towards Resilience: a reflection on Nepal's reconstruction and the future,"*** using Zoom application. The objective of the Webinar was to collect feedback from the partners on pertinent reconstruction issues at a time when the country is going through the nationwide lockdown due to COVID-19 pandemic and determine NRA priorities for the remaining time frame of NRA mandate, that is expiring in December 2020. The Executive Committee Member, Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha gave a presentation focusing on the theme of the Webinar along with key issues identified by the NRA for discussion among the partners followed by a question and answer session. Total 86 participants from various organizations participated in the webinar session. The Webinar recording can be accessed [here](#).

On 24 April 2020, NRA organized a separate webinar between donors, media, partner organizations and reconstruction professionals to reaffirm the NRA's commitments on proper and timely completion of reconstruction and to receive feedback for the way forward. The NRA presented the progress and achievement for the past four years and provided a platform to participants to review and reflect back on progress, lessons learned and to suggest next steps. The Panelist and participants including Mr. Anil Pokherel (CEO, NDRRMA) applauded the achievements and contributed their ideas and thoughts to ascertain priority areas for NRA to develop exit strategy and hand over plan. The NRA CEO Mr. Sushil Gyawali thanked participants for all the questions and suggestions, and these inputs will be helpful to plan the next steps forward. The presentation slides can be accessed here ([PDF](#)).



The National Symposium postponed: The National Symposium on Nepal's Reconstruction, planned for 22-24 April, as part of a preparation for the International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction (ICNR), has been postponed until further notice due to nationwide lockdown as a result of COVID-19 pandemic. In this situation, NRA has requested that all individual authors whose abstracts had been approved by the Editorial Board, to complete their research paper and submit the preliminary draft research findings to the NRA Conference Secretariat for review and further advice on the research papers.

Call for Contributions: Urban Recovery Compilations: HRRP is curating a compilation on urban recovery processes and case studies from different stakeholders engaged in urban recovery. The aim of the publication is to highlight the strengths and challenges in urban reconstruction and recovery through global and local case studies and innovative

approaches. Please reach out to sneha@hrrpnepal.org if you wish to contribute and share your story. For More information, contact Sneha Malani, Urban Recovery Advisor: sneha@hrrpnepal.org

Quarantine Site Assessment: HRRP in close coordination with UNRCO led the Quarantine site assessment. HRRP took lead responsibility in coordination, planning and monitoring of quarantine sites in **Bagmati** and **Gandaki** provinces. Please refer to [Bagmati](#) and [Gandaki](#) to see all the partners that supported in the assessment.

COVID-19 Pandemic: Live Updates & Nepal Humanitarian Response Update

With the lockdown being continued for over a month, reconstruction has been greatly impacted. Total 48 positive Coronavirus cases have been detected, (10 recovered and 41 undergoing medical treatment) as of 24 April. HRRP continues to participate in different clusters to share information and engage in different cluster meetings.

COVID-19 related Standards and Guidelines (MoPH, GoN)

- [Guideline on the use of Personal Protective Equipment \(PPE\) in the context of COVID-19](#)
- [COVID-19 SOP, Case Investigation and Tracing form](#)
- [Protocol for ILI clinics \(COVISOP COVID-19.pdfD-19 screening COVID clinics\)](#)
- [COVID-19 Patient Transport Team \(PTT\) Guideline to transport COVID-19 patients to hospitals and treatment centers](#)
- [Interim Clinical Guidance and Infection Prevention and Control Guideline for health institutions attending COVID-19 patients](#)
- [Brief procedure for the management of the bodies of people who died due to COVID-19](#)
- [Flow diagram for testing returnees for COVID-19 \(RDT or PCR\)](#)
- [Guideline on sample collection from people on COVID-19 quarantine](#)
- [Wondfo SARS-CoV-2 Antibody Test Procedure](#)
- [Interim guideline on delivery of COVID and other health care services in the context of COVID-19 epidemic - 2076](#)
- [Methods for Laboratory testing of COVID-19](#)
- [Safety measures to be followed at the point of entry \(import\) in the context of COVID-19 pandemic2077](#)

Let us all collectively work against stigma and misinformation through the pandemic



"Stigmatization could potentially contribute to more severe health problems, ongoing transmission, and difficulties controlling infectious diseases during an epidemic."

-WHO



"We're not just fighting an epidemic; we're fighting an infodemic"

- WHO Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus

Impacts of COVID-19 on Recovery and Reconstruction at District/Municipal Level



A month before the five-year memorial of the **Gorkha Earthquake** that hit Nepal on **25 April 2015**, Nepal decided to restrict movement and enforced a Nation-wide lockdown to contain the spread of COVID-19, a global pandemic wrecking havoc all around the world. Like many sectors affected, reconstruction and recovery efforts that largely depended on the market for construction materials, transportation and availability of masons and labourers, has also been affected.

The National Reconstruction Authority reports that 72.34% of private housing beneficiaries have completed reconstruction and that 27.66% (209,237 HHs) are at various stages of reconstructing their houses. Referring to [Grant Disbursement data as of 23 April 2020](#), there has been very low or no progress in tranche disbursement due to the lockdown. Prior to the lockdown, recovery and reconstruction activities were progressing at a smoother pace and NRA was aiming to complete reconstruction by December 2020. These plans have certainly been impacted by the current COVID-19 crisis and we will have more updates on these as the situation improves.

The Reconstruction Stakeholders at the District and Municipal level were asked to express their views on the current COVID-19 crisis impact on the reconstruction. Here is the general overview from different stakeholders across earthquake affected districts on the impact of COVID-19 on reconstruction and way forward.

DLIPU Grant Management and Local Infrastructure (GMAI) and Building

- GMAI offices have been closed since the lockdown. The lockdown has completely stopped our movement. Field level activities have been stopped.
- We the team of MIS Specialists under guidance from CLPIU GMAI have been working remotely through web-based applications (using websites), through Google sheets and uploading our tasks in respective folders of Google Drive. We are

currently working on documentation of PA collected before the lockdown, data cleaning, revisiting and reviewing MIS backlogs, analyzing the reports on reconstruction and reviewing the tranche distribution.

- Tranche distribution has not progressed. It has been stopped, which has affected people from reconstructing houses. No inspection files have been submitted to DLPIU offices because of which the tranche process has been affected, eventually hampering the reconstruction as people are not able to receive the amount.
- Banks have minimized their work, only few are operational and open.
- Very less communication is happening with the beneficiaries except with the ones who are continuing reconstruction. People are not doing major reconstruction due to absence of Engineers in the field as well.
- With extension of the lockdown and in view of the upcoming monsoon, the reconstruction could be pushed 5 -6 more months further.
- After the market and all other services resume, the Socio -Technical Assistance (STA) should continue to pick up the reconstruction pace.

Municipal/Ward Representatives

- There is no reconstruction work going on including other administrative works. For most of the Municipalities, the priority has shifted towards COVID-19 emergency response and support programs to minimize its impact.
- However, few people who are using local materials and those who were able to stock the materials like rebar and cements prior to the lockdown are continuing reconstruction works. Few people want to complete reconstruction before the NRA deadline and also before the monsoon starts, thus are continuing the work.
- There are people calling us to get information on tranche status, new beneficiary list. Some of our staffs have been attending to the needs of the beneficiaries regarding reconstruction
- Many of the masons and labors have returned to their home which has slowed down the reconstruction works. Mostly the economically poor and people depending on daily wage works have not been able to continue reconstruction or retrofitting despite their interests.
- There is a shortage of construction materials with no transportation. Thus, the reconstruction work has been affected despite local masons and labourers available in few places.
- The current COVID-19 crisis might delay the reconstruction works further by 4 - 6 months as it will take time to resume all the services and supply chains.
- We also must shift our priorities and focus on our daily works (administration, education, agriculture, health, reconstruction, social development), however, mode of operation and action plans have not been decided yet.

Technical (Engineers, Focal Persons)

- The lockdown has completely affected our work. We are not doing any work currently as the offices are closed and we are not able to go to the field. Thus, the house inspection has been stopped.
- It is also not easy and practical to guide the people who are reconstructing houses and are having technical issues without referring to the documents and examining the houses, as houses have different issues. On top of that, most beneficiaries are not equipped with web-based technologies.
- We are focusing on working on backlogs, addressing non-compliant cases, conducting structural analysis and preparing retrofitting designs for the houses visited before the lockdown.
- Beneficiaries have somewhat stopped contacting the Engineers since the lockdown. However, some Engineers who have remained in the field are in constant communication with wards and beneficiaries. Although municipal/ward offices are closed, beneficiaries contact with information on tranche updates, grievance redressal and for technical support and we have been providing recommendation, technical guidance to them as well.
- After the lockdown, continuation in Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) is crucial, along with the timely disbursement of tranche to speed up the reconstruction process.

Partner Organizations

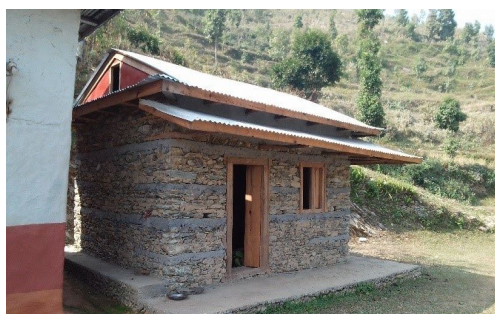
- COVID-19 has completely halted our program and our staff are working from home, remotely.
- We have not been able to provide technical assistance to the people who have been listed through grievance redressal.
- Most staff are working on the documentation part of the program. No or few adjustments have been done with the program as staff are not physically present at the working areas.
- The reconstruction will be pushed further by 4-5 months due to the current COVID-19 crisis and it might take a while for the markets to open.
- We are in communication with stakeholders and beneficiaries for any support required but reconstruction works have not been progressed so far.
- COVID-19 has negatively impacted our program, this might affect our timeline. Further, with many organizations' reconstruction programs coming to an end, DLPIU Engineers should cover up the gap to speed up the reconstruction process.
- In case of prolonged lockdown, the Government should ensure smooth supply of construction materials. While many of the people have been listed as reconstruction beneficiaries through the grievance process, providing Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) is very crucial post the lockdown and timely disbursement of tranches to the people to smoothly start reconstruction.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur Monthly Report, 26 Mar – 23 Apr 2020



Ward No 4, Mahankal Rural Municipality, Lalitpur:
Two room, stone in mud mortar house with attic and flexible roof. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 26 Mar – 23 Apr 2020



Ward 2, Ramechhap Municipality, Ramechhap:
Single room, stone in mud mortar structure. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant. The total cost of construction was 350,000 NPR.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Gorkha Monthly Report, 26 Mar – 23 Apr 2020



Ward 4, Jwalamukhi Rural Municipality, Dhading:
Two storey, stone in mud mortar structure. The house, 68% of the retrofitting process completed, has been stopped due to COVID-19 lockdown. The house has been retrofitted with support from Build Change/UNOPS.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Monthly Report, 26 Mar – 23 Apr 2020



Ward 2, Dakshinkali Municipality, Kathmandu:
Single storey, load bearing brick in cement mortar structure with CGI roof.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok Monthly Report, 26 Mar – 23 Apr 2020



Ward 3, Banepa Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: Single storey, two room interlocking block structure. The homeowner has received all three tranches of Government housing grant. The total cost of construction was 550,000 NPR.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Rasuwa Monthly Report, 26 Mar – 23 Apr 2020



Ward 3, Likhu Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: Single story, brick in cement mortar structure. The homeowner has received all three tranches of Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Lamjung, Tanahun, Kaski, Syangja Monthly Report, 26 Mar – 23 Apr 2020



Ward 10, Besisahar Municipality, Lamjung: Two storey, stone masonry in mud mortar house with light flexible CGI roofing. The homeowner has received a first tranche of Government housing grant. The plinth area is less than 1,000 sq. ft. The house is non-compliant.

FEATURED STORY



Featured Social Mobilizer, Bhagwati Tiwari,

Gone are the days and those moments seem like limited to only in dreams. Bhagwati now lives in a two-room house built with the assistance from the Government of Nepal, National Reconstruction Authority as she lost the house to the 2015 earthquake. She and her family had to live in a temporary shelter for six months and then moved to the damaged house after clearing the debris and bringing it down to one storey, which was not easy.

In the initial days, I was struggling with my work, and had no idea where to link the reconstruction support in the communities. After participating in the four-day training on “Social Mobilizers on earthquake resilient reconstruction” conducted by NRA and Building, I gained technical knowledge and skills in reconstruction including communication skills. As a result, it has been easier to work with the communities in supporting the NRA in its aim to build back better houses and resilient communities.

Social Mobilizers like Bhagawati are playing critical roles in reducing the gap in information flow, reaching the hard-to-reach communities with updated policy and guidelines from NRA. She also clarifies the issues related to reconstruction and encourages people to start reconstruction or retrofitting and get the tranche amount on time.

The people are happy now with the mobilization of Social Mobilizers and Mobile Masons in the field as they can get support and discuss their concerns whenever they want. She further adds, the job is rewarding - to see change in communities, people who were once against retrofitting are now opting to retrofit their houses. Some people in her community also remarked that their houses have become resilient with less amount of money than building the new one which is a very positive change in the communities.

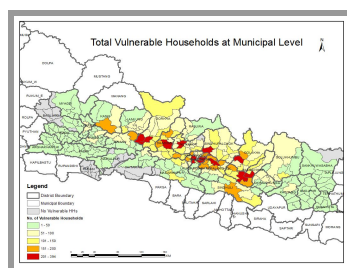
She is also equally concerned to find that some beneficiaries are still struggling to be enlisted in the beneficiary list even after registering grievance while those who have received the tranche have not paid serious attention to complete the construction of their houses. Some households do not feel the need while others do not have the capacity to complete the construction. She feels the need to increase monitoring and technical support of engineers to facilitate the reconstruction and endorsement for completion certificates.

On the whole, she is committed to contributing to timely completion of remaining reconstruction work by effectively playing her roles as a facilitator of communication and coordination between the Government of Nepal's reconstruction project and communities to build safer homes.

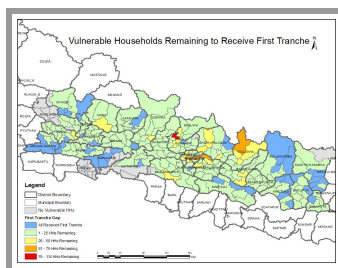
Vulnerable Households Reconstruction

Vulnerable Households: Of the **18,505** Vulnerable Households identified by National Reconstruction Authority (NRA), **62.6%** are elderly (> 70 years), **36%** are single women, **1%** people with disability and **0.4%** child headed households.

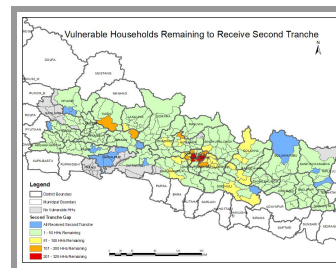
16,109 have received the first tranche, **11,267** have received second tranche and **9,136** have received third tranche. There are also 1,694 HHs that have not received first first and out of them 318 HHs have been supported by partner organizations. In total 1,970 HHs have been supported by various partner organizations.



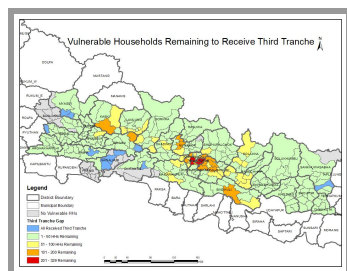
[Vulnerable HHs Coverage](#)



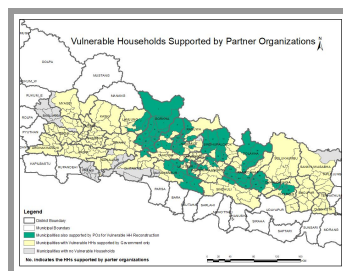
[First Tranche Gap](#)



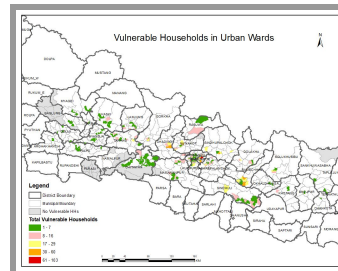
[Second Tranche Gap](#)



[Third Tranche Gap](#)

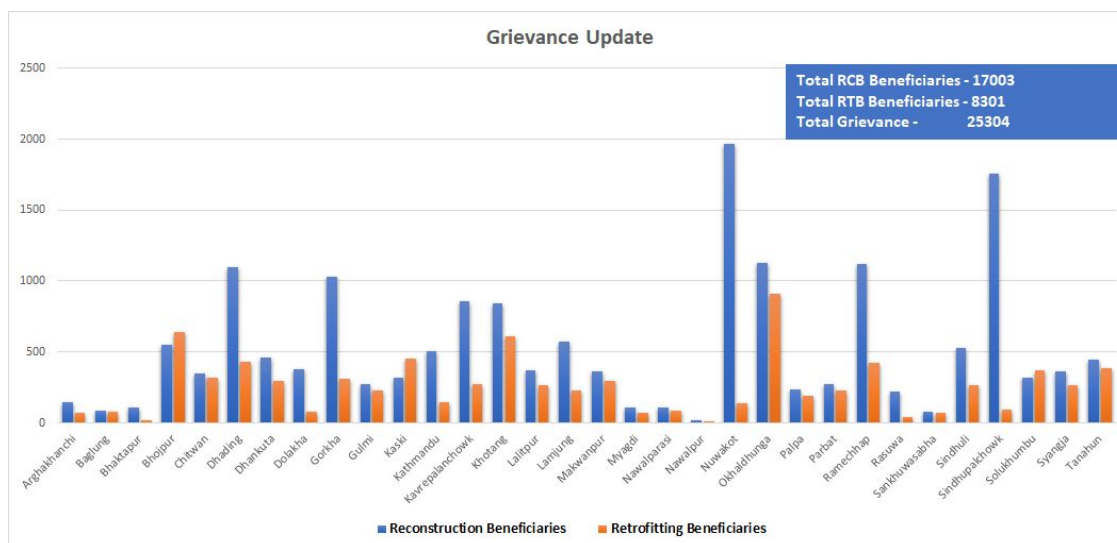


[Vulnerable Supported by POs](#)



[Vulnerable HHs Coverage in Urban](#)

Grievance Update: As of 20 April 2020, 25,304 grievances have been addressed by NRA of which 17, 003 HHs have been enlisted as Reconstruction beneficiaries and 8,301 as Retrofitting beneficiaries. Most households from Nuwakot and Sindhupalchok have been included in the reconstruction list while in Okhaldhunga, Khotang and Bhojpur households are in the retrofitting grant list.



Grievance Update: 25,304 grievances have been addressed by NRA of which 17, 003 HHs have been enlisted as Reconstruction beneficiaries and 8,301 as Retrofitting beneficiaries

Tranche Duplication and Tranche Recovered: Besides the Government of Nepal's support to housing reconstruction, Partner Organizations have been supporting the private housing reconstruction. Almost 23,000 HHs have been supported with the allocated tranche amount of 300,000 NPR directly by the partner organizations. Out of them, 1,093 HHs have received the double the tranche amount from both the Government and the partners. However, 1,066 people returned the first tranche, 22 have returned the second tranche and 4 have returned the third tranche to the Government.

MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



[Baliyo Ghar | Bhag 12 | 19 April 2020](#): This episode discusses the accomplishment of the NRA while it enters into the fifth year of its term and the impact of COVID-19 on the reconstruction. This program was aired on Kantipur Television on 19 April 2020 at 6:30 & 10:00 PM.

NATIONAL PRODUCTS

[Monthly e-newsletter of National Reconstruction Authority March 2020](#)

HRRP PRODUCTS



Palika Profiles (Municipal reconstruction profiles)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32-earthquake affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



Municipal dataset on Reconstruction

CSV, PDF

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

PARTNER PRODUCTS

Lesson Learned: Cash Transfer and Embedded Extension for Improved Goat Shelters in Post-Earthquake Nepal: This lesson learned document prepared by CRS-Nepal reveals the fact that how partners have contributed to earthquake beneficiaries to improve their quality of life through conditional cash transfer programs. It explains the modality of the support program, accomplishments of the cash transfers and its impact in the lives of the earthquake beneficiaries.

IRM Study by The Asia Foundation: The independent Impacts and Recovery Monitoring Project (IRM), led by The Asia Foundation (TAF) and funded by the UK Department for International Development (DFID), was implemented right after the Gorkha earthquake in 2015 and has undertaken research every 6 months since then, until April 2017, with an additional round in late 2019. The longitudinal mixed-methods study inquires into who is recovering, who isn't, what worked and what didn't work and why. The study + videos can be found through this [link](#)



Photo by Prabhat R. Jha

Helpline Services: Considering the psychosocial impact of the recent COVID-19, Transcultural Psychosocial Organization (TPO) Nepal has extended its helpline services to everyone who is in need. They provide both psychosocial and mental health services. Individuals and partners are encouraged to use this service from 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM everyday. TPO Nepal **HELPLINE Toll Free Number: 1660 01 0 2005** (call to this number is free of cost from NTC network).

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



CONTACT US

HRRP Nepal Office

Jawagal, Lalitpur, Nepal

Tel: (+977) - 01 - 5544149

Email: info@hrrpnepal.org

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